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JOHNS HOPKINS UNIVERSITY

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REFERENCES AT JOHNS HOPKINS UNIVERSITY

Prof. Olivier Jeanne ojeanne@jhu.edu	Prof. Jonathan H. Wright wrightj@jhu.edu	Prof. Alessandro Rebucci arebucci@jhu.edu
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EDUCATION

Johns Hopkins University <i>Ph.D. Candidate in Economics</i> <i>M.A. in Economics</i>	Baltimore, MD, United States Aug. 2021 - 2027 (expected) May 2024
Yonsei University <i>M.A. coursework in Economics</i> (degree not completed) <i>B.A. in Economics</i>	Seoul, Republic of Korea Aug. 2020 - Dec. 2020 Aug. 2020

FIELDS

International Macro-Finance, International Economics, Macroeconomics

JOB MARKET PAPER

Private Portfolio Retrenchment and Foreign Exchange Intervention in Emerging Markets

Abstract: This paper studies how domestic investors absorb global shocks in emerging markets and how private absorption shapes foreign exchange intervention (FXI). It develops a demand-system model in which residents' return-elastic retrenchment from foreign assets governs the optimal FXI policy as well as the transmission of foreign demand shocks to expected excess currency returns. Using a panel IV regression of 19 emerging markets, we find that private retrenchment is more elastic to return differential in countries with more intensive FXI. The model predicts stronger absorption when investors with flexible and internationally diversified portfolios hold more wealth. Consistent with this prediction, a 10-percentage-point increase in pension-fund and insurance-company assets relative to GDP is associated with a roughly 10 percent larger semi-elasticity. Security-level data on Colombian pension funds show that their net purchases of foreign securities fall when expected excess currency returns rise, consistent with the mechanism. Finally, controlling for pension-fund and insurance-company assets widens the estimated difference between floaters and interveners in the response of expected excess currency returns to VIX changes.

WORKING PAPER

[1] Quantifying the regional dominance of the Greenback in trade invoicing

Abstract: The U.S. dollar's role as global dominant currency is well known in international economics. However, less is known about its role at the regional level largely due to a lack of statistics. This paper shows that the dollar acts as a strong dominant currency of invoicing even in intra-regional trade everywhere except Europe by estimating the dollar's share in bilateral trade invoicing. It also shows that the currency's share in bilateral trade invoicing is largely decided by currency anchoring, as well as price complementarity and distance between the two.

PUBLICATIONS

[3] Household Indebtedness and the Macroeconomic Effects of Tax Changes

With Sangyup Choi, *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization*, May 2023

Abstract: This study investigates whether household indebtedness influences the macroeconomic effects of U.S. tax changes. By applying a state-dependent local projection method to the exogenous tax shock series, we find that a tax cut is more effective in stimulating output when the economy is characterized by higher household indebtedness. The household debt-dependent tax policy is primarily driven by (i) the response of private consumption, not private investment; (ii) changes in personal income tax, not corporate income tax, suggesting the relevance of a higher MPC of constrained households in understanding the documented state dependence. In response to a tax cut, labor supply also increases more during a high-debt state, which is consistent with the micro-level evidence on the labor supply of constrained households, thereby contributing to higher tax multipliers. Our findings are robust to a battery of sensitivity checks, especially controlling for the additional states of the economy considered in the literature.

[2] Are Government Spending Shocks Inflationary at the Zero Lower Bound? New Evidence from Daily Data

With Sangyup Choi and Seung Yong Yoo, *Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control*, June 2022

Abstract: Are government spending shocks inflationary at the zero lower bound (ZLB)? Exploiting newly constructed high-frequency data on government spending and the price index of the U.S. economy, we find that prices decline in response to a positive government spending shock at the ZLB. Government spending shocks are also more deflationary at the ZLB than during normal times. While our finding is difficult to reconcile with standard New Keynesian models, which predict a larger fiscal multiplier following fiscal expansion at the ZLB—driven by rising inflation and a falling real interest rate—a model with credit constraints can explain this anomaly.

[1] Bitcoin: An Inflation Hedge but Not a Safe Haven

With Sangyup Choi, *Finance Research Letters*, August 2021

Abstract: During the recent COVID-19 pandemic, many commonalities shared by Bitcoin and gold raise the question of whether Bitcoin can hedge inflation or provide a safe haven as gold often does. By estimating a vector autoregression (VAR) model, we provide systematic evidence on the relationship among inflation, uncertainty, and Bitcoin and gold prices. Bitcoin appreciates against inflation (or inflation expectation) shocks, confirming its inflation-hedging property claimed by investors. However, unlike gold, Bitcoin prices decline in response to financial uncertainty shocks, rejecting the safe-haven quality. Interestingly, Bitcoin prices do not decrease after policy uncertainty shocks, partly consistent with the notion of Bitcoin's independence from government authorities. We also find an interesting asymmetry in the drivers of Bitcoin price dynamics between the bullish and bearish market. The main findings hold with or without the COVID-19 pandemic episode.

PRESENTATIONS

Yonsei Emerging Researchers Forum

July 2026, Seoul, Republic of Korea

Midwest Economics Association

March 2026, Chicago, IL, USA

Second DMV Macro Ph.D. Student Symposium

March 2025, Baltimore, MD, USA

IMF SPR-MP Workshop

Sept. 2024, Washington, D.C., USA

RESEARCH / POLICY EXPERIENCES

International Monetary Fund

Washington, D.C., United States

Fund Internship Program: SPR-MP

June 2024 - Sept. 2024

- Researched the effects of natural disasters on public debt and fiscal reaction.
- Led empirical research using event studies and an empirical fiscal reaction function.

Johns Hopkins University

Maryland, MD, United States

Research Assistant to Prof. Alessandro Rebucci

Jan. 2023 - Aug. 2023

- Estimated Bayesian VAR model to analyze the effects of sales flow shocks on the U.S. bond interest rates.

Yonsei University

Seoul, Republic of Korea

Research Assistant to Prof. Sangyup Choi

2019 - 2021

- Reduced-form analysis of bond-level financial market data to investigate the effects of uncertainty shocks on bond prices.
- Estimated time-varying parameter VAR models to analyze the effects of uncertainty shocks on macroeconomic variables in different periods.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant at Johns Hopkins University

Financial Markets and Institutions F2025, F2026

Corporate Finance S2025

Topics in International Macroeconomics and Finance F2024, S2026

Debt Crises and Financial Crises S2024

Elements of Macroeconomics F2023

Teaching Assistant at Yonsei University

Macroeconomic Theory (in English) 2019 - 2020

Analysis of International Financial Market (in English) 2019 - 2021

SKILLS / OTHER INFO

Statistics & Datascience: Python, STATA, R, Matlab, Excel, Bloomberg Terminal**Document Processing:** L^AT_EX, Microsoft Office**Language:** Korean (Native), English (Fluent), Spanish (Basic)**Citizenship:** Republic of Korea